Report of Generative AI Use

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Module: Computer Vision (CSU44053)
Assignment: Pool ball detection and recognition

1 Statement of AI use

I used ChatGPT as a technical assistant throughout this assignment to discuss computer vision methods, review design alternatives, help translate ideas into C++/OpenCV code, troubleshoot implementation problems, and improve the organisation and writing of my report. I proposed each approach that was used, including the separation of ball detection and recognition, automated Hough parameter testing, colour-based recognition, and later segmentation and histogram-based experiments. ChatGPT also provided substantial code examples and, at several points, complete or corrected implementations; I reviewed, adapted, tested and evaluated this code against the assignment images.

For the written report, I used AI to write a template and help organise the strucuture of the report. It also helped with proof reading, and the phrasing of some paragraphs I had trouble formulating on my own.

2 Main Uses and Prompts

2.1 Understanding the Brief

> "I have a computer vision assignment I am working on. It is important that you do not give me a solution. Just act as a guide and help me though my own solution. This assignment will use OpenCV and C++. I will also provide my lecture notes so we can stay in the scope of the module. It is important to use traditional computer vision techinique and not a neural network. I will attach the assignment brief."

Impact on project: Explaination of the brief, noted that there are seperate training and eval images. Noted that it will not propose full solutions and that we should use traditional CV techniques

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> "It seems like we cannot use the Table1-6 for training. So that means we can only tweek parameters on the AllBalls image right? But would we be allowed to look at the validation results and find general patterns that we are missing and then build new experiments around those errors?"

Impact on project: Noted that yes we cannot use the Table1-6 for training, e.g. parameter tweeking. Also if we wanted to structure new experiment around the validation result this should be noted.

2.2 Help for Detection

"For this assignment let's first work on the ball detection. I think the best approach is to use a Hough circle transform."

Impact on project: Explained that the circle Hough transform would be good start and propose starting parameters and what each parameters did.

"We have been trying to find the best Hough manually. This is super time consuming. I think we should be able to automate this process using the test image. I want to test a large amount of parameters (a few hundred combinations) without manually testing them all. If we can, we should also evaluate each config in a specific way. For the next stage we can only recognise ball that have been detected. So we should focus on getting pretty much 100% recall. Then focus on precision to avoid getting too many FPs. We can validate afterwards on Table1-6."

Impact on project: Outputed that automation would be a good idea. proposed a range of parameters to test (200+, I later increased it to 480 in the final pipeline after more experimenting). Also proposed the validation structure from my criterias.

"We recently learnt about watershed segmentation. Could we use this method to improve detection on regions where balls are closely clustered together? Could you help me implement an experiment for this?"

Impact on project: Helped implement an experiment for watershed segmentation. After testing this experiment the performance didn't not change much. So this was not included in the final pipeline. This led to another idea to improve detection; using a more permissive hough in the ball clusters and the current hough everywhere else. This experiment manage to catch 1 missing ball but added a lot more FP and complexity so was also left out of the final pipeline

2.3 Help for Recognition

"For recognition I initially think we could just use HLS maybe?"

Impact on project: Explained that it was a good simple start. Gave some starting boundaries I could test.

"Actually! could we try k-means? with k=2 then hopefully we can extract 2 colour clusters. Then we can examine what these clusters are (light, dark, colour) using some thresholds. Then we can look at the proportion of these colour regions for each ball and see if they are stipped, full or the cue ball. full should be primariy dark or colour pixels, stripped should have a larger proprotion of light and have dark/colour pixels and the cue ball should be all or mostly light. Then we could use Hue to get the colour of the ball. We can also test other k sizes, k=2 just seem like the simplest and most logical."

Impact on project: Helped implement this k means exepriment and the visualisations. We tested with k = 2,3,4,5. With k=2 we were getting optimal performance on the test images so there was not enough evidence to switch to a larger k.

"We did a tutorial where we had to detect taffic cones (the orange and white ones). We used at some point to see if there was a white part 'sandwhiched' between two orange regions. For stripe balls this could be useful maybe, at least when the orientation is good. Essentially, stripe balls should have 3 main regions with two white and one colour in the middle. Can you help me write an experiment to test this?"

Impact on project: Also helped me plan and implement this experiment. Some initial tests on the validation image were performing worse. So it was left as an experiment

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"maybe since we have the training image we could use histogram backprojection / Bhattacharyya for better colour recogntion?"

Impact on project: The biggest help AI provided in helping me plan and implement the histogram training based on the colours of the balls in the training image. Backprojection was only used to visulise the similarities and instead the Bhattacharyya distance was used to compute histogram comparaison

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"I am thinking. One thing that we have not yet taken into account is that balls are unique. Thus, instead of having 'hard' decisions for each ball we can have probabilities or scores. Then we can pick based on the combination that maximises the probabily or scores. I think there is an algorithm that does this but I do not remeber the name or how it works exactly"

Impact on project: Gave the name of the algorithm I was missing (hungarian algorithm) proposed a Guassian function for the scores.

"Yes that makes sense. A Gaussian function makes sense, we could also try a linear one first, maybe its peformance can be similar."

Impact on project: We implement this 'uniqueness' experiment using both linear and gaussian functions. Guassian ultimatly performed better.

"Another thing that could be interesting is that, specifically for duplicated cue balls. We could expand on pixels around the detection and see if there are colour pixels beyond the white (ofc this would be tough for green balls given the green mat). This is because a common error, is that sometimes the hough transform detects the smaller inside white circle of the balls instead of the full ball."

Impact on project: We tested multiple padding 1-5 pixels. 1pixel worked the best and is what was kept

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"The padding is working well. One last thing I would like to try, is to use the fact that all ball have roughly the same size. So is there are still duplicate white balls then we could use the estimate size at a certain dept to determine which ball is the acctuall white cue. Additionally, to make it simplier we could also use a simple heuristic that says that the larger of the two should be the correct white ball. Then we don't have to compute estimate ball sizes at all depths."

Impact on project: We tested both the simpler and more complex solution. The complex solution involved taking the training image and fitting a line relating detected radius to the center row using the 16 balls. We then divided each candidate radius by the expected radius at its row. Both method produced the same improvements so we kept the simpler radius rule.

2.4 Report writting

Used some repetive prompts such as:

"Help me rephrase this"

"Help me make this sound better"

2.5 Help for Code/Syntax

Used some repetive prompts such as:

"Help me debug this"

"Help me restructure this code in a nicer way"

"Help me write a function for ..."

"Help me draft an experiment for ..."

"How can I implement this in OpenCV?"

3 Coverage checklist

Summary of AI usage in the assignment.

- Planning the detection and recognition pipeline.
- Generating, modifying, consolidating or formatting C++ code.
- Debugging and explaining code or algorithms.
- Designing experiments, parameter searches and interactive tools.
- generating latex template for the report and AI usage document